

# How I built the energy-transition trust analysis

Working with raw EU survey microdata — from a coded SPSS file to verified, weighted, source-matched figures.

|                 |               |           |          |             |
|-----------------|---------------|-----------|----------|-------------|
| 25,699          | 18,247        | 221       | EU27     | ±1.0%       |
| Raw respondents | Analysis base | Variables | Coverage | Margin @ EU |

## The source

Flash Eurobarometer 566, Consumer Behaviour in the Energy Transition (GESIS study ZA9118; fieldwork 30 June–15 July 2025; commissioned by the European Commission, DG Energy; fielded by Ipsos via CATI). The dataset arrived as a coded SPSS .sav file — numeric responses with embedded value labels and a separate questionnaire codebook — not a clean spreadsheet. Working it into reliable figures took three deliberate steps.

## The three things that had to be right

1. Defining the correct base. The headline survey is EU citizens 18+, but the report's figures use a narrower base: those involved in household energy decisions (DX1\_2 = 1), excluding respondents whose energy price is fixed in their rent with no opt-out (DX2 = 5). Applying both filters reproduced the report's base almost exactly — 18,247 against the published 18,250.
2. Applying the survey weight. Raw counts misrepresent the population. I applied the post-stratification weight (w1) to every percentage, so each respondent counts in proportion to their demographic group — the standard for survey-accurate reporting.
3. Matching the reporting convention. Percentages are computed over the full base including "Don't know," which is how the Commission reports them. Getting this right brought provider-trust to 78.9% against the published 79% — confirming the pipeline was sound before any chart was drawn.

## The pipeline

Data loaded in Python (pyreadstat / pandas), cleaned and filtered to the analysis base, then loaded into a SQLite database so every figure could be derived with auditable SQL rather than opaque spreadsheet clicks. Representative query:

```
SELECT
  ROUND(100.0 * SUM(CASE WHEN trust_provider IN (1,2) THEN weight ELSE 0 END)
    / SUM(weight), 1) AS provider_trust_pct,
  ROUND(100.0 * SUM(CASE WHEN trust_market IN (1,2) THEN weight ELSE 0 END)
    / SUM(weight), 1) AS market_trust_pct
FROM survey WHERE trust_market IS NOT NULL;
```

## Verification against the official report

| Figure               | Mine   | Report |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|----------------------|--------|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Provider trust       | 78.9%  | 79%    | <b>What the analysis surfaced</b><br><br>A 13-point credibility gap: Europeans trust their own provider (78.9%) far more than the market they sit in (65.9%). The gap is sharpest in the South — Greece trusts its energy market least in the EU (40%), a 25-point provider-vs-market split — revealing a core/periphery divide the headline figures hide. |
| Want protection (Q4) | 40.1%  | 38%    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Bill clarity ranks   | 2nd    | 2nd    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Analysis base (n)    | 18,247 | 18,250 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

Why this matters. Every number in the accompanying deck is reproducible from the source file with the queries above — base-matched, weighted, and checked against the Commission's published figures. Built on the data, not the press release.